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Snake on keyboard

Jeroen Domburg has successfully hacked a backlit mechanical keyboard and now the classic game of Snake can be played right on it <http://dgit.in/SnakeKeyb>

Noteworthy news moments from India and around the globe – even Mars!

With murmurs of Tesla launching in India, and Google's bonanza-filled online shopping festival in the offing, check out what else happened this month



Mangalyaan in TIME's top inventions of 2014

Selfie stick along with Apple Watch, Mangalyaan, Blackphone and Coolest Cooler have made it in Time Magazine list of top 25 inventions of 2014. Selfies have become a phenomenon across the globe in 2014. The selfie stick enables you to capture a selfie from any angle of your choice by positioning your smartphone beyond the arms reach.

Time said, "If 2013 was the year in which selfie became a buzzword, then 2014 was the year selfies became a cultural phenomenon."

"Look no further than a recent Pew report, which found that at least a quarter of Americans have shared a selfie on a social-networking site (including Ellen Degeneres, Kim Kardashian and President Obama)," it added.

The technology "adds genuine value," says Van Baker, a mobile tech analyst at the research firm Gartner. "I've seen a lot of people using it." Apple's much awaited Apple Watch is also on the list. Time Magazine stated that Apple Watch "wholly reimagines the computer for the wrist, using a novel interface that combines a touchscreen and physical buttons". It noted

that that the Apple Watch can send messages, give directions, make payments, track fitness and much more. The smart-watch is expected to be launched in Spring of 2015 with prices starting at \$349.

India's Mangalyaan is on the number two spot in the list. Describing India's first Mars mission, Time Magazine said, "Nobody gets Mars right on the first try. The U.S. didn't, Russia didn't, the Europeans didn't. But on Sept.24, India did."

Apart from this Blackphone that puts privacy at the forefront and the Coolest Cooler which was the top-funded campaign on Kickstarter are also on the list.

Tesla coming to India?

Electric car maker Tesla Motors is now eyeing the Indian market as it plans to launch a sedan especially designed for emerging markets. According to reports, Tesla is making a third generation car – a compact and affordable four door sedan, dubbed as Tesla Model 3.

"Our target price for Model 3 is in the range of \$30,000 to \$40,000 (approx Rs 18-24 lakh) that makes it an ideal product in the luxury car segment,"

Jay Vijayan, chief information officer at Tesla Motors is quoted as saying.

Vijayan also acknowledged that Tesla cars are expensive for the Indian market. It's current vehicle Tesla Model S is priced above \$100,000. He adds: "India is a huge potential market, but we need to have more affordable and economical cars."

He also expressed hope to receive subsidy on electric cars from the Indian government, similar to the US government, which bundles electric car with at least \$7500 direct subsidy. He believes the government backing will be a key factor in helping launch cars in the Indian market.

"India has one of the highest import duty in the world – in excess of 100% – that goes against our principal of importing car directly from our plants at Fremont in the US or the assembly unit in Netherlands," Vijayan added.

"We have identified India is one of the potential markets in Asia to have a local assembly plant, but we need a definite policy from the government to support electric vehicles in the future," he further said.